Chapter Sixty

The Appearance of the Ottomans

Between 1302 and 1347,
the Ottoman Turks appear in Asia Minor,
the Catalan Company arrives at Constantinople,
and the emperors of Constantinople find themselves at constant war

ANDRONICUS II, second emperor of the Byzantine restoration, was facing a new upheaval.

Five or six years before, the village of Sogut had suddenly awoken. Sogut lay in the lands of the Turkish Sultanate of Rum; since its conquest by the Mongols in 1243, the Sultanate had existed in name only, its sultan a figurehead, the real power in the hands of Il-khanate viziers.

But beneath the surface of Il-khanate control, the Turks of Rum were restless.

Rum was home to a kaleidoscope of Turkish tribal alliances: Eskenderum, Eskisehir, Konyali, all of them possible challengers of the Il-khanate overlords. Sogut lay at the center of those three tribal territories, home to a small tribe led by the Turkish chief Osman. And sometime shortly after 1290,